of private property without proper consent is 'unreasonable' unless it has been authorized by a valid search warrant." *Camara* v. *Municipal Court,* 387 U. S. 523, 528–529 (1967).

See *Coolidge* v. *New Hampshire,* 403 U. S. 443, 454–455 (1971); *id.,* at 512 (WHITE, J., concurring and dissenting); *Stoner* v. *California,* 376 U. S. 483 (1964); *United States* v. *Jeffers,* 342 U. S. 48 (1951); *McDonald* v. *United States,* 335 U. S. 451 (1948); *Agnello* v. *United States,* 269 U. S. 20 (1925).

The respondents do not contend that business premises are not protected by the Fourth Amendment. Such a proposition could not be defended in light of this Court's clear holdings to the contrary. *See* v. *City of Seattle,* 387 U. S. 541 (1967); *Go-Bart Co.* v. *United States,* 282 U. S. 344 (1931); *Silverthorne Lumber Co.* v. *United States,* 251 U. S. 385 (1920). Nor can it be claimed that corporations are without some Fourth Amendment rights. *Go-Bart Co.* v. *United States, supra; Silverthorne Lumber Co.* v. *United States, supra; Oklahoma Press Pub. Co.* v. *Walling,* 327 U. S. 186, 205–206 (1946); *Hale* v. *Henkel,* 201 U. S. 43, 75–76 (1906). Cf. *California Bankers Assn.* v. *Shultz,* 416 U. S. 21 (1974); *Federal Trade Comm'n* v. *American Tobacco Co.,* 264 U. S. 298, 305–306 (1924); *Wilson* v. *United States,* 221 U. S. 361, 375–376 (1911); *Consolidated Rendering Co.* v. *Vermont,* 207 U. S. 541, 553–554 (1908).

The Court, of course, has recognized that a business, by its special nature and voluntary existence, may open itself to intrusions that would not be permissible in a purely private context. Thus, in *United States* v. *Biswell,* 406 U. S. 311 (1972), a warrantless search of a locked storeroom during business hours, pursuant to the inspection procedure authorized by the Gun Control Act of 1968, 18 U. S. C. § 923 (g), was upheld:

"When a dealer chooses to engage in this pervasively

> regulated business and to accept a federal license, he does so with the knowledge that his business records, firearms, and ammunition will be subject to effective inspection." 406 U. S., at 316.

See also *Colonnade Catering Corp.* v. *United States,* 397 U. S. 72 (1970) (Congress has broad authority to fashion standards of reasonableness for searches and seizures to regulate the liquor industry but failed in that case to authorize a warrantless search).

In the present case, however, the intrusion into petitioner's privacy was not based on the nature of its business, its license, or any regulation of its activities. Rather, the intrusion is claimed to be justified on the ground that petitioner's assets were seizable to satisfy tax assessments. This involves nothing more than the normal enforcement of the tax laws, and we find no justification for treating petitioner differently in these circumstances simply because it is a corporation.

The respondents argue that there is a broad exception to the Fourth Amendment that allows warrantless intrusions into privacy in the furtherance of enforcement of the tax laws. We recognize that the "Power to lay and collect Taxes" is a specifically enunciated power of the Federal Government, Const., Art. I, § 8, cl. 1, and that the First Congress, which proposed the adoption of the Bill of Rights, also provided that certain taxes could be "levied by distress and sale of goods of the person or persons refusing or neglecting to pay." Act of Mar. 3, 1791, c. 15, § 23, 1 Stat. 204. This, however, relates to warrantless seizures rather than to warrantless searches. It is one thing to seize without a warrant property resting in an open area or seizable by levy without an intrusion into privacy, and it is quite another thing to effect a warrantless seizure of property, even that owned by a corporation, situated on private premises to which access is not otherwise available for the seizing officer.